

PAINTIANO

The Book of Golden Music — a summary

On finding beauty between tone and colour · RafFel

The book tells the story of a desire two and a half thousand years old: to join what we hear with what we see. Pythagoras at his string, Newton over the prism, Castel at his colour harpsichord, Scriabin with his keyboard of light, Disney in Fantasia, David Byrne today — different hands, different centuries, the same dream. Paintiano is the instrument in which that dream can, for the first time, be held in your hand.

Tone and colour are the same wave

Concert A — 440 hertz — raised by forty octaves becomes a warm red. Sound is a wave in the air, light a wave in the field; they are only forty doublings apart. The whole system stands on this bridge: hue carries the pitch, octave carries the lightness, the force of the keystroke carries the saturation. A bass C2 is dark blue, a soprano C7 almost white; forte is saturated, pianissimo barely a shadow.

Four views of one wheel

Twelve tones can be laid onto the colour wheel by four rules: Harmony (the circle of fifths — the musician's view), Spectrum (the chromatic rainbow — the physicist's view), Kontra (complementary intervals — the painter's view) and ϕ (the golden angle of 137.5° — nature's view). A fifth view, Custom, waits for your own map. There is no single right answer — there are four true ones.

It lives in all of us

Synaesthetes have always seen music — and science shows that a piece of the synaesthete sits in each of us: high tones bright, low tones dark, sharp sounds sharp shapes (bouba and kiki). When you say “dark music”, you are not speaking in metaphor. That is why little Lara at the piano paints her sadness blue without anyone having taught her.

A picture that plays

The rule can be turned around: if a tone can become a colour, a colour can become a tone. Load a photograph, Guernica or a child's drawing — and Paintiano plays it. There and back, without loss. And the same piece can be seen through eighteen pairs of eyes: Picasso breaks the shapes, Pollock lets the paint fall, Kusama sees dots, Klimt glows in gold — every view true, because beneath them all runs the same deterministic mathematics: the same song, the same painting, every time.

*“Music has colour. It always had.
We simply forgot.”*

The whole book — thirteen chapters, free in nine languages

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